imperialism. The modern type of finance-imperialism added new kinds of economic exploitation which were unknown in earlier ages. The record of British rule in India during the nineteenth century must necessarily depress and anger an Indian, and yet it illustrates the superiority of the British in many fields, not least in their capacity to profit by our disunity and weaknesses. A people who are weak and who are left behind in the march of time invite trouble and ultimately have only themselves to

** Quoted by Edward Thompson, 'The Life of Lord Metcalfe:*

blame. If British imperialism with all its consequences **was, in** the circumstances, to be expected in the natural order of **events,** so also was the growth of opposition to it inevitable, and the **final** crisis between the two.

The Growth of the Indian States System

One of our major problems in India to-day is that of the Princes of the Indian states. These states are unique of their kind in the world and they vary greatly in size and political and social conditions. Their number is 601. About fifteen of these may be considered major states, the biggest of these being Hyderabad,